Axles and alignment

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Use measurements and observations to improve straight rolling.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Check axle parallelism and wheel clearance.
2. Record a repeatable alignment test.
3. Use evidence to choose one adjustment.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

01 Bring back an earlier idea

A motor uses 5 W for 7 s. Find electrical energy and name a possible non-mechanical output.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Explain a worked example

Reference: clearance = available gap - part width.
Use positive clearance and check free rotation. Alignment and wheel rubbing are separate checks; change one feature at a time.

Worked reasoning: Parallel axles can still cause drag if wheels rub the chassis. Alignment and clearance are separate checks; a straight top view does not verify free rotation.

Your turn: Draw a top view and a side detail marking an axle direction and a wheel gap.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Look and explain

On your top-view sketch, mark both axle lines. Add a check for parallelism and show clearance between each wheel and the chassis.



Top view: the large rectangle is the chassis; small rectangles are wheels; the two crossbars are axles.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

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Continue down each column.

04 Build the solution

A supplied free-roll test moves forward 100 cm and ends 8 cm to the right of the start line. Record both measurements with units. Plan three actual trials before and after one adjustment.

Trial	Forward (cm)	Side offset (cm)
1		
2		
3		

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

05 Use the idea

A car veers right once. Does that prove the rear axle is crooked? Name another possible cause and a discriminating check.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Choose a method

A 4 W device runs for 6 s. Find transferred energy.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

Write the single adjustment you made and one observation that will tell you whether it helped.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: Apply it another way

A car veers left. Propose two different causes and a test that separates them before changing both at once.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3